Weekly cetuximab + irinotecan

> **Supportive prescription draft for review.** This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

Day 1 · chemotherapy and antibody

Active medicines: Cetuximab + Irinotecan

Emetogenic risk: Moderate

Medicine	Dose / route	When
Chlorphenamine	10 mg intravenous (IV) bolus	At least one hour before cetuximab Repeat for subsequent cetuximab infusions; assess prior infusion reactions.
Dexamethasone	8 mg IV bolus	At least one hour before cetuximab on Day 1 This corticosteroid also covers the treatment-day corticosteroid part of antiemesis where appropriate. Pharmacy must reconcile route, dose and timing; do not automatically add a second 8 mg antiemetic dose.
Ondansetron	16 mg PO once	Before Day 1 chemotherapy NCIS V8 moderate-risk row; consider QT risk, low electrolytes, interactions and the individual prescription.
Dexamethasone	8 mg PO daily	Days 2 and 3 after the administered Day 1 chemotherapy NCIS V8 delayed prophylaxis. Reconcile with any other steroid prescription; re-anchor dates if treatment is delayed.
Metoclopramide	10 mg PO up to three times daily as required	Rescue nausea treatment only as prescribed NCIS V8 rescue option; check contraindications, renal function, interactions and prescribed duration.
Atropine sulphate	250 micrograms subcutaneously	Before irinotecan when prescribed; assess acute cholinergic symptoms Avoid in glaucoma. Use with caution in asthma; review suitability before prescribing. This treats/prevents the acute cholinergic syndrome; it is not the delayed-diarrhoea rescue medicine.

Additional phase-specific support

- Antiemetic classification refers to the active treatment day. Reconcile duplicate steroid entries before prescribing.
- No automatic granulocyte colony-stimulating factor (white-cell growth support) (G-CSF) schedule is added; use the patient's neutropenia history, risk and consultant plan.
- Cetuximab premedication and infusion observation remain necessary even on an antibody-only day.
- Start local EGFR skin care; monitor magnesium, calcium and potassium before and periodically during therapy, then monthly for two months after the final dose.
- Provide a written irinotecan delayed-diarrhoea rescue and escalation plan before treatment; distinguish it from immediate infusion-related cramps/sweating. Fever, severe pain, dehydration or diarrhoea not responding to the prescribed plan needs urgent review.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00330 v6 · p4 · NCCP antiemetics v8, Table 1 pp4–5

Day 8 · weekly cetuximab only

Active medicines: Cetuximab

Emetogenic risk: Low

Medicine	Dose / route	When
Chlorphenamine	10 mg intravenous (IV) bolus	At least one hour before cetuximab Cetuximab premedication remains applicable.
Dexamethasone	8 mg IV bolus	At least one hour before cetuximab Reconcile low-risk antiemesis with this corticosteroid; do not duplicate steroids.
Metoclopramide	10 mg PO up to three times daily as required	Rescue only as prescribed No automatic delayed steroid course is carried over from Day 1 chemotherapy.

Additional phase-specific support

- Cetuximab only: no irinotecan, oxaliplatin, fluorouracil or atropine is scheduled on Day 8.
- Continue skin care, electrolyte monitoring, infusion precautions and the urgent contact plan.
- Low-risk antibody-only antiemesis is distinct from Day 1 moderate-risk chemotherapy prophylaxis.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00330 v6 · p4 · NCCP antiemetics v8, Table 1 pp4–5

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · SACTCheck v0.83.8 · Regimen-level drafts; prescriber and oncology-pharmacy verification required